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Q4. (a) Write a note on field work tradition and its importance in the development of Anthropology 20

Fieldwork is the backbone of anthropology. It is the first hand study of the society by collecting details personally.

History and Development

1) LH Morgan was first to conduct fieldwork among Troquois Indians. He employed genealogical method.

However, it was WHR Rivers who popularized genealogical method in his study 'Genealogical Method in Anthropological Perspective (1910)'

2) Later Franz Boas in his expedition to Baffin Island conducted fieldwork among Kwakiutl ~~ist~~ of British Columbia.

- 3) Haddon led the ~~exp~~ Torres strait expedition in 1899-1900.
- 4) Radcliffe Brown in his study on Andaman Islanders employed field work tradition that helped him develop the theory of structuralism.
- 5) Malinowski in his study of Tobian and Islanders (1922) popularised participant observation.
- 6) In India, Prof LP Vidyarthi conducted fieldwork among Maler and by Verrier Elwin among Baigas.

Importance of Field work

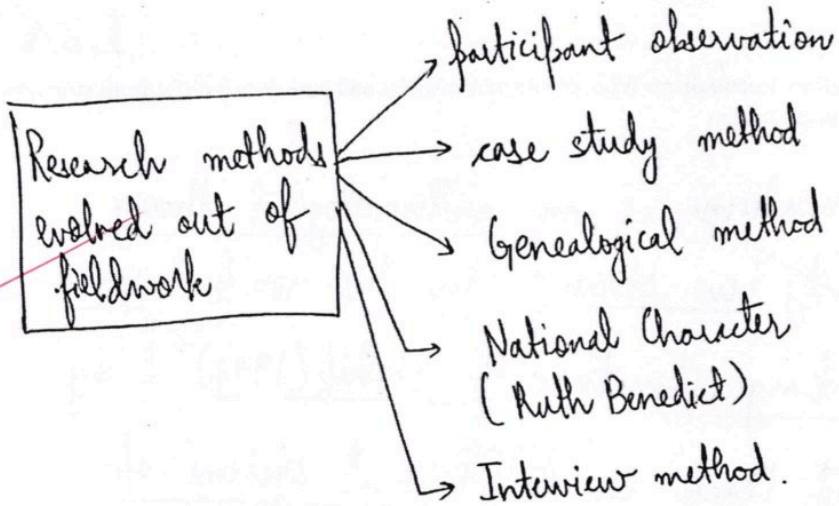
- 1) It helped develop anthropology as a empirical subject
- 2) It helped gain in depth knowledge of the society.

- 3) Various new insights were gained ~~the~~ about various cultures through fieldwork. eg: Kula exchange by Malinowski.
- 4) Applied and Action anthropology developed as a result of fieldwork.
- 5) Helped in policy formulation for tribal development. eg: Tribal sub plan by Prof Vidyaathi & Prof SC Dube
- 6) Cultural relativism emerged through fieldwork

Hence, fieldwork tradition helped anthropology to develop as a frontier science.

Various new contemporary fieldwork tradition also emerged

↳ Harold Conklin (1968) argued that importance of ethnographer is ~~is~~ immense in fieldwork.



There is increased relevance of fieldwork tradition in anthropology. It has enabled various cross cultural studies, ethnography studies and comparative study in anthropology.

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